europass

Blen Assefa Tilahun

Nationality: Ethiopian **Date of birth:** 20/06/2001 **Phone:** (+33) 671086608 **Email:** blenassefa59@gmail.com

Home: Avenue paul langevin villeneuve d'ascq, 59650 Lille (France)

EDUCATION AND TRAINING

Masters of Computer Science with speciality in Cybersecurity and IoT

University of Lille [01/09/2025 – Current]

City: Lille | **Country:** France

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

Addis Ababa University [30/09/2019 – 16/08/2023]

City: Addis Ababa | **Country:** Ethiopia

WORK EXPERIENCE

Upwork – Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

City: Addis Ababa | **Country:** Ethiopia

Software Developer - Freelance

[01/12/2024 – 31/08/2025]

- Develop software products based on functional requirement documents
- Maintain high quality of product by refactoring codebase and following industry best practices

Africa To Silicon Valley – Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

City: Addis Ababa | **Country:** Ethiopia

Lead of Academy and Software Engineer

[09/12/2022 – 09/12/2024]

Led multiple leadership roles, driving cross-functional collaboration and operational success. Became **the first woman** among 300 employees over five years to receive a prestigious company recognition awarded to only 10 individuals.

- As a Deputy Lead of Remote Education,
  - Led online tech education program, developed and implemented a strategic roadmap that streamlined operations that would support 100+ African students from around 20 countries.
- As a project lead and backend lead developer
  - Designed a comprehensive data model and user flow for a startup fintech system, establishing foundational architecture that clarified project objectives and accelerated backend development timeline by 30%.
  - Orchestrated the backend team creating epics, sprints and tasks using **Atlassian Jira** and **Agile methodologies** providing clear goals for the team and completing 90% of the project in 3 weeks.
  - Reviewed pull requests and ensured standards and quality of code base .
  - Created detailed documentation, leading to successful onboarding experiences for 5 new developers within two weeks.
  - **Technologies: GoLang, GraphQL, PostgreSQL.**
- As web application developer,
  - Led end-to-end development and maintenance of the official A2SV website,
    - Optimized SEO and enhanced website performance, achieving 100% SEO and 90% performance scores.
  - Designed and built a website for Africa's Largest Hackathon, A2SV Hackathon 2024 website
    - The website handled over 60 thousand views and used for registering nearly 5,000 hackathon participants
    - Optimised Cloudinary high bandwidth usage from 515GB to 46GB by observing high traffic and engagement from google analytics.
  - **Technologies: VueJs, Cloudinary, Figma, ReactJs, Angular, GCP, Cloudflare**

Eskalate – Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

City: Addis Ababa | **Country:** Ethiopia

Software developer

[01/04/2022 – 30/03/2023]

- Worked on a web and an android application, called Atrons, that students can use to search and share resources.
- Collaborated with a team of 25. The project won $8000 after being judged by Jelani Nelson and Ricardo Baeza-Yates
- Implemented authentication from backend using firebase
- Implemented backend of book filtering APIs and models using NodeJs and helped with the frontend integration
- Tested endpoints and code logics using Jest testing framework

LANGUAGE SKILLS

Mother tongue(s): Amharic

Other language(s):

English

LISTENING C1 **READING** C1 **WRITING** C1

SPOKEN PRODUCTION C1 **SPOKEN INTERACTION** C1

French

LISTENING B2 **READING** B2 **WRITING** B2

SPOKEN PRODUCTION B2 **SPOKEN INTERACTION** B2

Levels: A1 and A2: Basic user - B1 and B2: Independent user - C1 and C2: Proficient user

SKILLS

Python, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, C, PHP, C++, Typescript, C#, Java / React, Vue, Node.js, Tailwind, React Native Django, Python Flask, MySQL, MongoDB / Object Oriented Programming, Test Driven Development, Design Pattern, Linux Systems

HONOURS AND AWARDS

[17/10/2024] Africa to Silicon Valley

AI for Impact Hackathon organiser The A2SV AI for Impact Hackathon for Africa, Grand Finale unfolded from **October 12-17, 2024.** The experience was an awe-inspiring evolution from an initial **1,118 teams** to the top **8 finalists**, proudly representing 7 African countries. And I was awarded certification of appreciation for my efforts organising this event.

Link: https://drive.google.com/file/d/1mss9Hbkg8SEpmIBka7Lco7rL2lyfnpSa/view?usp=sharing

[30/10/2020] CS50 Harvard

CS50x Introduction to Computer Science Completed CS50X Introduction to computer science course from Harvard University including 9 problem sets and one final project

Link: https://certificates.cs50.io/7224ed07-fae7-4e61-8c5f-dd6d6c59386f.pdf?size=letter

[29/01/2025] University of Maryland

Software Security non Credit Course An online non-credit course authorized by University of Maryland, College Park and offered through Coursera.

Link: https://drive.google.com/file/d/1SdB0PUwMUZQm5Hk5pdN1w6VYRel7PE97/view?usp=sharing